

SHERIF ABAZA

EXPERIENTIAL BUSINESS LEAD · NBA
APPLICATION

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Available

Worldwide

BASKETBALL BACKGROUND

NATIONAL YOUTH PLAYER

ACTIVE COACH · 500+ PLAYERS

25+ YEARS IN THE GAME

GLOBAL BASKETBALL LANDSCAPE

BASKETBALL

National Youth Player

Egypt — competed at regional & national youth level

Coach

Youth & community teams, 10+ years, 500+ players developed

Global Perspective

NBA, EuroLeague, FIBA, grassroots — all markets

The Culture

Jordan era to present — the sport as entertainment

CORE SKILLS

Event Production & Activation

Fan Experience Design

Global Operations

Brand & Partnerships

Community Building

Entertainment & Creative

Stakeholder Management

LANGUAGES

Arabic

Native

English

Native

French

Excellent

Spanish

Excellent

Dutch

Working

Polish

Working

Portuguese

Basic

Basic

PROFILE

Entrepreneurial events and activations leader with **27+ years building public experiences, fan moments, and brand activations** at global scale — and a lifelong basketball player and coach with genuine insider fluency. Built a 140-person event agency in Dubai, delivered activations for the FIFA Club World Cup, Paris 2024 Olympics, and COP 27/26/29 across 40+ countries. I think entertainment-first, operate under pressure, and believe the NBA's greatest opportunity lives beyond the arena.

EXPERIENCE

SPHERE EVENTS & COMMUNICATION

2008 – 2013

FOUNDER & MANAGING DIRECTOR Dubai, UAE

- Founded and scaled a regional event & communications agency into a **140-person operation delivering 150+ projects per year**, generating USD 8M+ in annual revenue at peak
- Led major public entertainment events including **Street Nights, Dubai Chocolate Festival, and Marina Music Festival** — designing crowd experiences from zero for audiences of tens of thousands
- Partnered with global brands (Adidas, Emirates Airlines, Abu Dhabi Tourism, FIFA, Siemens, Porsche, Emaar) on activations blending creative ambition with flawless operational delivery across the region
- Built cross-functional teams (production, design, logistics, client services) and the systems and supplier networks to sustain high performance in high-pressure environments

ABAZA BUSINESS SERVICES

2019 – Present

FOUNDER & DIRECTOR Netherlands

- Delivered activations and event operations for the **FIFA Club World Cup** and the **Paris 2024 Olympic Games** — operating at the highest level of global sports production
- Designed and delivered **end-to-end activations for COP 27 (Egypt), COP 26 (UAE), and COP 29 (Azerbaijan)** — coordinating multinational teams and on-site logistics at true global scale
- Built agile operational frameworks enabling complex multi-country programs to run reliably across time zones under high-stakes conditions
- Strategic advisor on event design, logistics, and delivery for senior government and corporate clients — translating creative vision into structured execution plans

WITHLOCALS B.V.

2018 – Present

CHIEF COMMUNITY & GROWTH OFFICER Eindhoven, Netherlands

- Built and scaled a global community of **2,000+ experience hosts across 40+ countries** for a travel marketplace — deep expertise in community design and engagement at scale
- Scaled from 50 to 300+ cities; pivoted to virtual experiences during the pandemic, launching a platform serving **70+ global corporate clients**
- Partnered with Product & Engineering on the internal tools and dashboards that powered host performance and operational clarity

Italian

Romanian

Basic

GLOBAL REACH

100+ countries
visited & operated in

3 continents
of primary operations (MENA,
Europe, Americas)

40+ countries
with direct operational delivery

EDUCATION

B.Sc. Computer Engineering
Arab Academy for Science,
Technology & Maritime Transport,
Alexandria

FRONTFLIP (ME360)

2010 – 2013

CEO, MIDDLE EAST & NORTH AFRICA

Kansas City, USA / MENA

— Co-founded regional operations of a mobile loyalty startup; raised USD 1.8M in early-stage funding; built a 25-person cross-functional team

— Led market localization and UX design for one of the region's earliest app-based customer engagement platforms

ASDAA BURSON-MARSTELLER & SUNDANCE EVENTS

2004 – 2006

SENIOR ACCOUNT MANAGER & OPS

Dubai, UAE

— Key role in launching the inaugural Dubai International Film Festival — stakeholder engagement and event logistics at global scale

— Managed clients including Siemens, Adidas, and Hilton; coordinated cross-functional teams across high-profile campaigns and public events

LEADERSHIP DEVELOPMENT

AIESEC International (1999–2004) — Held progressive leadership positions including Local Committee President and National Support Team roles; led cross-cultural teams and international exchange programs across youth leadership and entrepreneurship. Thrived in diverse, high-energy environments that continue to inform my leadership approach.